



THUS PERISH ALL TYRANTS

THE ASSASSINATION OF
JULIUS CAESAR (44 BCE)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Fall of the Roman Republic

BEFORE

509 BCE Rome becomes a republic in which a small number of wealthy families share power.

202 BCE Rome defeats Carthage in North Africa and the empire expands rapidly.

88–82 BCE Civil war between rival generals Sulla and Marius tips the republic into crisis.

AFTER

31 BCE Octavian's victory at the Battle of Actium leads to his accession as Rome's first emperor and the end of the republic.

79 CE Vesuvius erupts, destroying Pompeii.

2nd century CE The Roman Empire reaches its greatest extent, with a population of around 60 million people.

On March 15, 44 BCE, the life of Julius Caesar, dictator of Rome, came to a bloody end at the hands of a faction of aristocratic senators who were determined to rescue the Roman Republic from what they saw as Caesar's tyranny. In reality, the dictator's death did not save the republic: it merely unleashed

The **oligarchic** political system in the **Roman Republic** is corrupt and decaying.



Rome's **nobility** dominate the **Senate**, protecting their privileges at the expense of political change, leading to a **crisis of the republic**.



After successful military campaigns, **Julius Caesar becomes dictator** and forces **political and social reforms** on the nobility.



Fearing Caesar's popularity and power, a group of senators assassinate him.



Octavian wins the civil war to determine Caesar's heir. Calling himself **Augustus**, he becomes the **first emperor of Rome**.



Augustus ensures that **the office of emperor** survives by making **Tiberius** his heir, transforming Rome into a **hereditary monarchy**.